LESSON 3

Mary had a little lamb

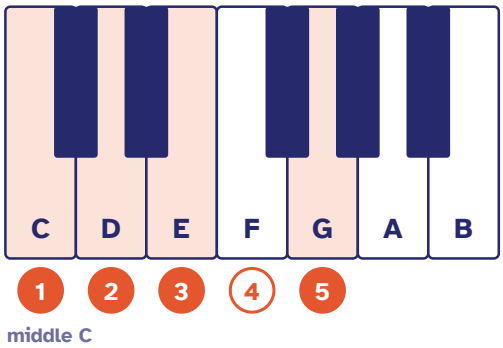
A rhyme by Sarah Josepha Hale, first printed in Boston in 1830, about a lamb that followed a girl to school. We sing it to the tune of *Merrily we roll along*.

IN THIS SONG **4/4** **four notes: C D E G** **the C position** **steps and a skip**

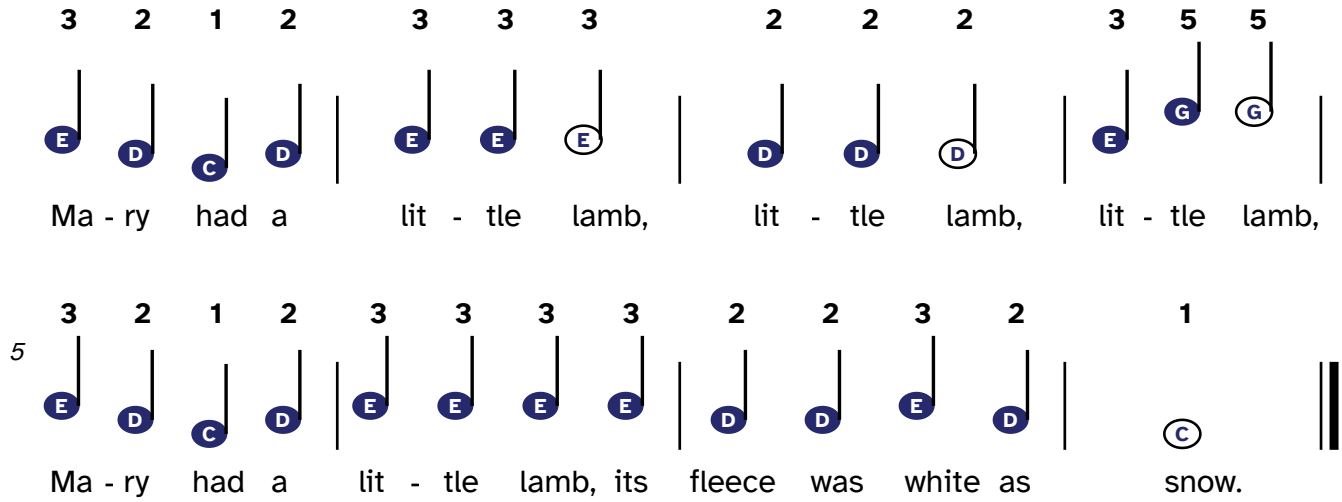
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words.



Your hand: C position. Right thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G. The song's notes are lit.
Steps and a skip. Most notes move by a step, to the next key. Only once does the tune skip a key: E up to G.



THE WOW MOMENT
Spooky Mary. Move your whole hand so the thumb sits on A, two keys down from C, and play the song with the same fingers. Same song, new house: it turns dark and minor. Your first spooky music.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

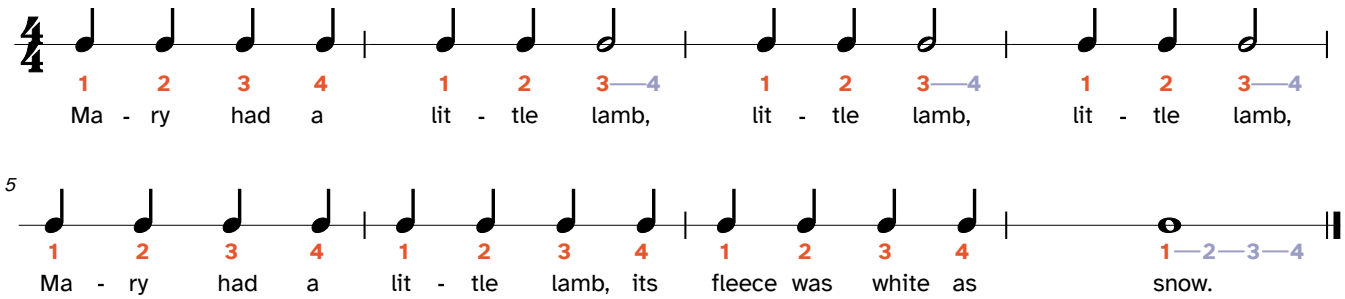
THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

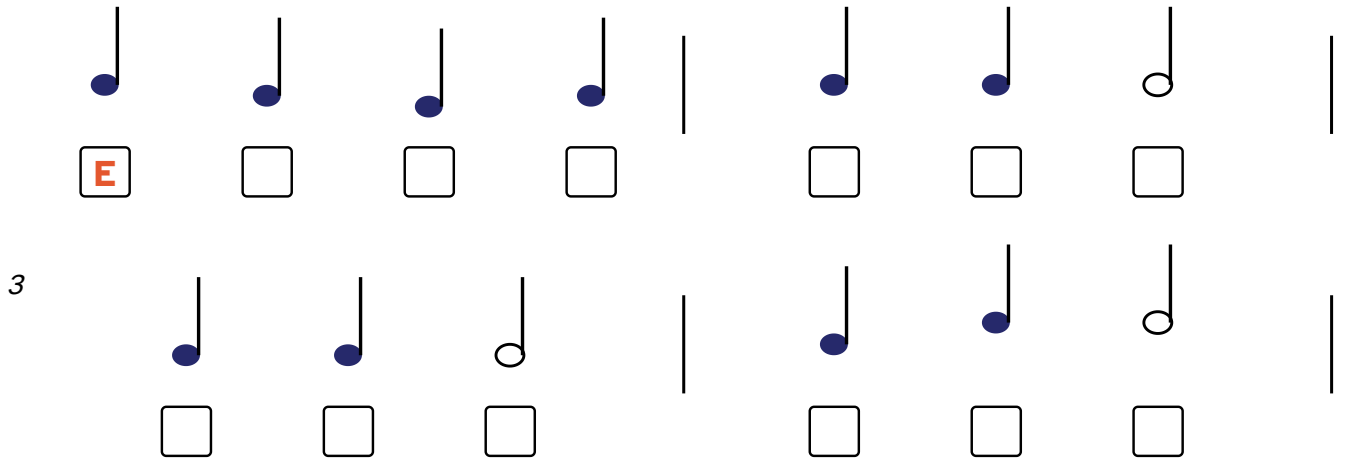
THE NOTES

crotchet — 1 beat ●
minim — 2 beats ●●
semibreve — 4 beats ●●●●



THE NOTES

Write the letter name of every note in the first four bars; the first one is done. Then find the skip: in which bar does the tune jump from E up to G? ☐



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

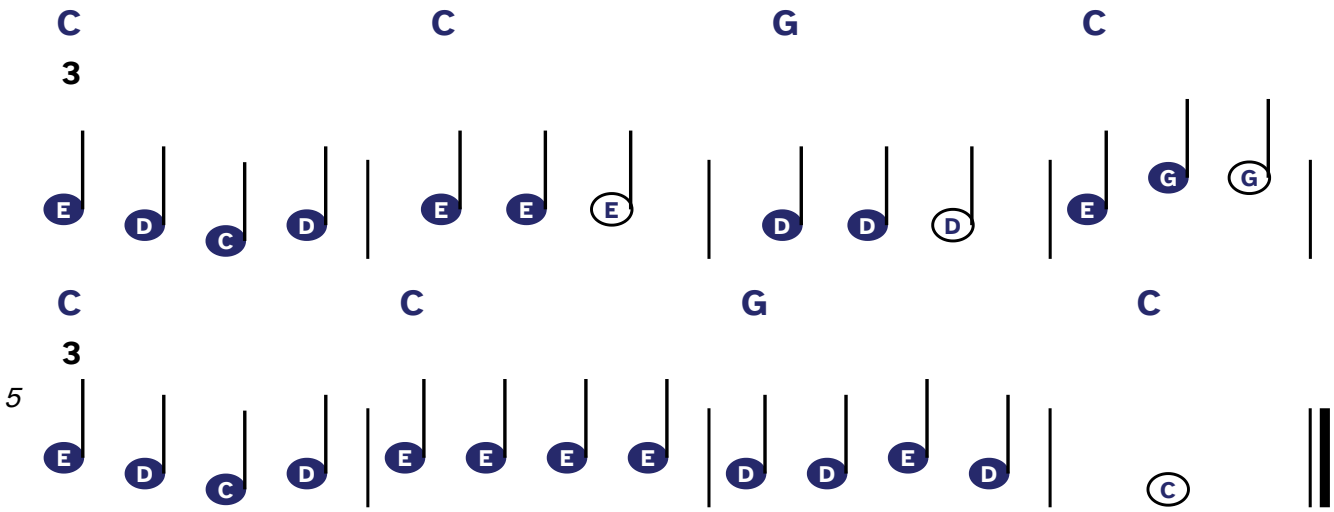
3 Lead sheet

The tune, with only the chord names above it. Two names in this song: C and G.

THE NAMES

A name tells the band which chord to play under the tune. Your left hand learns to play them from Lesson 4.

C G



1 Circle every G

2 Play the tune; your teacher plays the names

3 Say the names in time while your teacher plays

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find the skip, E up to

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

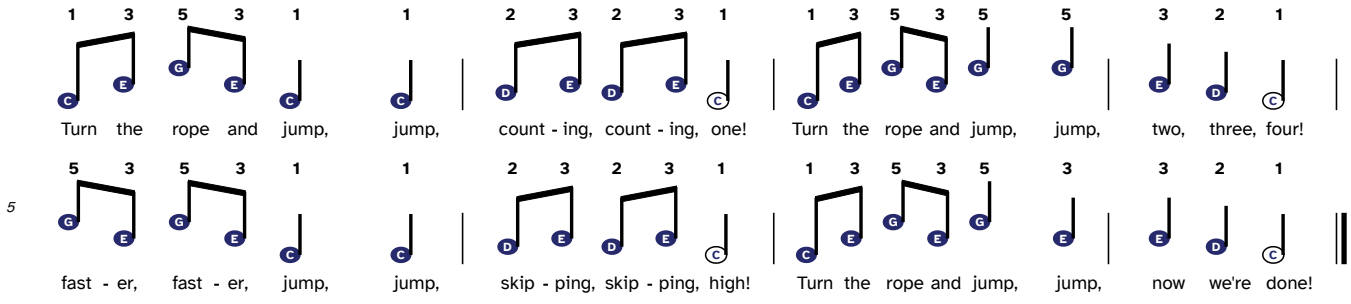
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

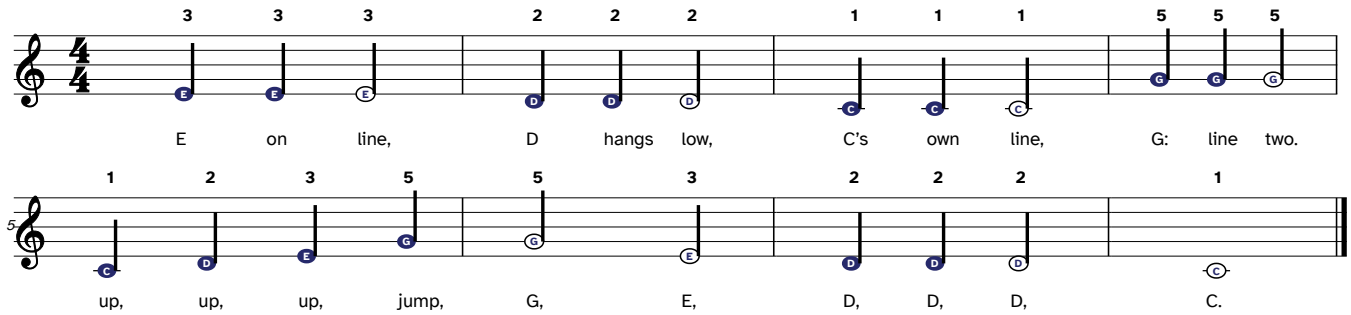
JUMP ROPE

Bouncy and quick: the four keys with skips, C E G, like a rope going round. Keep the running notes light.



HELLO, STAFF

Calm and careful, a peek at Lesson 4: the same notes on five lines. E sits on the bottom line, D hangs below it, C has a little line of its own, G sits on line two.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Spooky: thumb on A, the same fingers**
- ☐ **Skipping: light and bouncy, like Mary's lamb**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Left hand, twice
4. Spooky Mary, thumb on A

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S